

Reading - Improve Your Reading Score Overnight

7 original questions | Reading and Writing

Complete the questions before turning to the answer explanations. Mark any guess, even if it turns out to be correct. For math, show your setup and check the requested quantity. For reading, identify the exact supporting detail; for grammar, identify the clause or subject.

These questions were authored for this workbook from the lesson topics. They are not official SAT questions or copies of the course's paid practice.

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[Lesson video: Improve Your Reading Score Overnight](#)

1. A historian found that a port's tax receipts rose sharply between 1710 and 1720. During the same period, the city lowered its tax rate on each shipment. The historian argues that the receipts provide evidence of expanding commerce rather than higher taxes on existing trade.

Which finding would most directly support the historian's argument?

- A) The number of shipments entering the port more than doubled during the period.
- B) The city's tax rate remained higher than that of a neighboring port.
- C) Several merchants complained about the complexity of the tax forms.
- D) Tax receipts from 1700 were smaller than those from 1705.

2. In a study of urban gardens, insect visits increased after gardeners planted additional native flowers. However, the increase occurred only in gardens that already had nesting habitat nearby. The researchers therefore caution that planting flowers alone may not produce the same result in every garden.

Which conclusion is most logically supported?

- A) Native flowers discourage insects from nesting.
- B) Nesting habitat may influence whether additional flowers attract more insect visits.
- C) Every garden with nesting habitat will attract the same number of insects.
- D) Non-native flowers are always more effective than native flowers.

3. The library's old catalog listed a manuscript as anonymous. A newly discovered letter identifies its author, but the letter was written fifty years after the manuscript and cites no source. Researchers have consequently treated the identification as a promising lead rather than a settled attribution.

Which choice best states the main idea?

- A) The old catalog is certainly more accurate than the new letter.
- B) Researchers consider the letter useful but insufficient to establish authorship.
- C) The manuscript was written fifty years before the author was born.
- D) Anonymous manuscripts cannot be attributed to specific authors.

4. Biologists measured the time required for two seed types to germinate under the same laboratory conditions. The results are shown in the table. A researcher claims that the treatment reduced germination time more for Type A than for Type B.

Which comparison most directly supports the claim?

Seed type	Untreated (days)	Treated (days)
A	14	8
B	12	10

- A) Type A took 8 days with treatment, whereas Type B took 10.
- B) Type A's time fell by 6 days, whereas Type B's time fell by 2.
- C) Type A took 14 days without treatment, whereas Type B took 12.
- D) Both types germinated more quickly with treatment.

5. Many early maps emphasized coastlines and major roads. One mapmaker instead carefully marked wells along a desert route. Those wells were often separated by distances that travelers could cover in a single day. This detail suggests that the map was designed partly to help people plan journeys rather than merely to record landforms.

What is the function of the underlined sentence?

- A) It presents evidence supporting an interpretation of the map's practical purpose.
- B) It explains why early maps never included roads.
- C) It introduces a competing account that the text later rejects.
- D) It shows that the mapmaker had measured every traveler's walking speed.

6. The engineer's initial model was deliberately modest: it aimed to predict whether a bridge component would fail, not the precise moment at which failure would occur. Later models addressed the timing question.

As used in the text, what does "modest" most nearly mean?

- A) Unreliable
- B) Limited in scope
- C) Embarrassed
- D) Inexpensive

7. Two species of coastal plants can survive salty water. In field surveys, Species X was found mainly on exposed beaches, while Species Y was found mainly in sheltered inlets. When grown under identical sheltered conditions, however, both species grew equally well. These results suggest that the field distribution of Species X _____.

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) proves that it cannot survive in sheltered settings
- B) may reflect factors other than an inability to grow in sheltered conditions
- C) was caused entirely by differences in salt tolerance
- D) will remain unchanged in every future survey

Answers & explanations

Count correct answers, but also review correct guesses. Redo missed questions after a day without looking at the solution.

1: A 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: A 6: B 7: B

Why each answer works

1. Answer: A. An increase in shipments directly supports expansion in trade volume and explains rising receipts despite a lower per-shipment rate. B compares cities, C addresses administration, and D concerns an earlier period.

2. Answer: B. The effect varied with nearby nesting habitat, suggesting habitat influences the response. The text does not establish harm, equal outcomes, or superiority of non-native flowers.

3. Answer: B. The researchers neither reject the lead nor accept it as conclusive. A overstates the catalog's reliability, C invents chronology, and D asserts an unsupported impossibility.

4. Answer: B. Compare the change within each type, then compare those changes: A declines $14 - 8 = 6$ days and B declines $12 - 10 = 2$. A and C compare levels; D omits which reduction was larger.

5. Answer: A. The spacing of wells supports the interpretation that travelers could use the map to plan daily stages. B contradicts the opening, and C and D add claims not present.

6. Answer: B. The contrast concerns how much the model attempted to predict, so modest means limited in scope. The text does not evaluate cost or reliability.

7. Answer: B. Equal growth under sheltered conditions undercuts the claim that X cannot grow there. The data allow other explanations but do not establish one sole cause or a permanent distribution.

For each missed or guessed question, record the skill, the condition you overlooked, and one specific action for next time.